

LaNya Hood

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Professional Summary

Emerging AI/ML engineer and University of Michigan senior (Human-Centered Data & AI) with hands-on experience building GenAI-enabled applications, integrating large language models via APIs, and developing multi-agent and RAG-based workflows. Proven ability to collaborate across technical and non-technical stakeholders, contribute to responsible AI practices, and apply emerging automation and digital engineering concepts in fast-changing environments. Authorized to work in the U.S. without sponsorship.

Education

The University of Michigan – Ann Arbor | B.G.S, Human-Centered Data & AI

Expected May 2026

• NSBE, ColorStack, Black@SI, Black Student Union, BlackGen Capital | 180+ Volunteer Hours

Relevant Experience

AI Training Contractor

March 2026 – Present

Handshake AI

- Support the build and testing of GenAI-enabled systems by processing multimodal data (audio, visual, text) for Project Hedgehog.
- Provide structured evaluation feedback to improve LLM accuracy, generalization, and performance across diverse content formats.
- Contribute to operational support artifacts and technical documentation for GenAI use cases.

Data & Operations Consultant, Intern

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Sandbox Services

- Integrated AI-driven forecasting tools and APIs to optimize digital platform workflows and user engagement.
- Conducted user research and feature design sessions with C-suite to align UI/UX and data solutions with business needs.
- Built automated dashboards and data visualization pipelines; troubleshoot integration and data flow issues in development environments.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with product and operations teams to ensure solutions met governance and efficiency standards.

Data Specialist, Intern

June 2024 – Dec 2024

University of Michigan College of Engineering

- Maintained cloud-based AWS data pipelines and centralized databases, ensuring data integrity, accuracy, and security.
- Supported platform services in development environments; troubleshoot and reported technical issues to improve system reliability.

IT Project Engineer, Contractor

June 2023 – Aug 2023

MacroConnect

- Deployed and configured servers, firewalls, and network infrastructure; provided end-user support for K-12 and government clients.
- Gained hands-on experience with security assessments and ethical hacking, reinforcing responsible technology practices.

Leadership & Additional Experience

Founder – Lead Photographer & Editor

May 2018 – Present

Hood Photography

- Leverage OpenAI APIs for pricing simulations and AI-assisted workflows; building a LangChain-powered chatbot for scheduling and client FAQs.
- Demonstrate continuous learning by applying emerging AI tools and automation concepts to real-world business operations.

Co-Founder, Partnerships & Outreach

July 2024 – May 2026

BIPOC Builders

- Built digital outreach tracking systems and cross-sector partnerships, demonstrating ability to collaborate with diverse stakeholder groups.

Key AI & Technical Projects

- **Multi-Agent Fact-Checking System:** Built a 4-agent LangGraph pipeline (Retriever, Skeptic, Verifier, Explainer) integrating LLMs via API for evidence-grounded NLI verification — directly aligns with LLM integration and workflow orchestration responsibilities.
- **RAG Pipeline (SI 376):** End-to-end GenAI application combining BM25 + dense embedding retrieval with NLI verification; designed prompt specifications and evaluated with Recall@k metrics.
- **Single Agent (ReAct):** Adaptive AI agent with dynamic retrieval strategies, confidence gating, and prompt engineering — troubleshoot integrations and data flows in test environments.
- **NeighborGrid:** AI-integrated data and project management platform for government/non-profits; designed with API integrations and cross-platform workflow orchestration.
- **Photography Business Chatbot:** LangChain + OpenAI API application built end-to-end; demonstrates GenAI application development from prompt design to deployment.

Technical Skills

Languages & Scripting: Python, R, SQL, PowerShell, C++

GenAI & AI/ML: LLMs, Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, RAG, Multi-Agent Systems, LangChain, LangGraph, OpenAI Codex, Google Gemini, Responsible AI, Data Governance, Vibe Coding, Claude Code

APIs, Cloud & Platforms: APIs, AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Workspace, Jupyter Notebook, Visual Studio, RStudio, Excel, Adobe Photoshop

Soft Skills: Cross-functional collaboration, technical documentation, stakeholder communication, problem-solving, adaptability, attention to detail

Certifications: Google AI Essentials (Coursera) · Azure Essentials Professional (LinkedIn Learning) · Google AI Professional Certificate (In Progress)